

AWS INTERVIEW CHEAT-SHEET

For DevOps Engineers (Fresher & Experienced)

1. EC2 – Quick Interview Notes

Core Concepts (1-Line Answers)

- **EC2:** Virtual servers in AWS to run applications.
- **AMI:** Template to launch EC2 instances.
- **EBS:** Block storage attached to EC2.
- **Security Group:** Stateful firewall at instance level.
- **Key Pair:** Used for secure SSH access.

Most Asked Questions

- **Stop vs Terminate**
 - Stop: Instance stops, data retained
 - Terminate: Instance deleted, data lost
- **AMI vs Snapshot**
 - AMI: OS + configuration
 - Snapshot: Backup of EBS volume
- **How to secure EC2**
 - Security groups
 - IAM roles
 - Disable root login
 - Use private key rotation

Common Scenarios

- **EC2 not reachable**
 - Check Security Group
 - Check subnet route table
 - Check IGW attached
 - Check key pair
- **High CPU usage**
 - CloudWatch metrics
 - Scale instance
 - Enable Auto Scaling

2. S3 – Quick Interview Notes

Core Concepts

- **S3:** Object storage service
- **Bucket:** Container for objects
- **Object:** File + metadata
- **Storage Classes:** Standard, IA, Glacier

Most Asked Questions

- **S3 vs EBS**
 - S3: Object storage, scalable
 - EBS: Block storage, EC2 dependent
- **How to secure S3**
 - Bucket policy
 - IAM policy
 - Block public access
 - Encryption
- **Versioning**
 - Protects against accidental deletion

Common Scenarios

- **Accidental file deletion**
 - Enable versioning
 - Restore previous version
- **Public data exposed**
 - Block public access
 - Audit bucket policy

3. IAM – Quick Interview Notes

Core Concepts

- **User:** Human access
- **Role:** Service-to-service access
- **Policy:** Permission document (JSON)
- **Least Privilege:** Give minimum access required

Most Asked Questions

- **IAM User vs Role**
 - User: Long-term credentials
 - Role: Temporary credentials
- **Inline vs Managed Policy**
 - Inline: Attached to single entity
 - Managed: Reusable

Common Scenarios

- **EC2 needs S3 access**
 - Create IAM role
 - Attach S3 policy
 - Attach role to EC2
 - **AWS keys leaked**
 - Rotate keys immediately
 - Disable compromised user
 - Audit CloudTrail
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4. VPC – Quick Interview Notes

Core Concepts

- **VPC**: Virtual private network
- **Subnet**: Network segment
- **Public Subnet**: Has internet access
- **Private Subnet**: No direct internet
- **IGW**: Internet Gateway
- **NAT**: Outbound internet for private subnet

Most Asked Questions

- **Security Group vs NACL**
 - SG: Stateful, instance level
 - NACL: Stateless, subnet level
- **Why private subnet**
 - Security
 - No direct internet exposure

Common Scenarios

- **EC2 has no internet**
 - Check route table
 - Check IGW
 - Check subnet type
 - **DB exposed publicly**
 - Move to private subnet
 - Restrict security group
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5. CloudWatch – Quick Interview Notes

Core Concepts

- **Metrics:** Performance data
- **Logs:** Application/system logs
- **Alarms:** Trigger actions on metrics

Most Asked Questions

- **Metrics vs Logs**
 - Metrics: Numbers (CPU, memory)
 - Logs: Text data (errors, events)
- **CloudWatch vs CloudTrail**
 - CloudWatch: Monitoring
 - CloudTrail: API auditing

Common Scenarios

- **High CPU alerts**
 - Create alarm
 - Scale instance
 - Investigate logs
 - **Application logs missing**
 - Check log agent
 - Check permissions
 - Check log group
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6. DevOps-Focused AWS Interview Scenarios (Very Important)

Scenario 1

CI/CD pipeline needs artifact storage

- Use S3
- Enable versioning
- Secure with IAM role

Scenario 2

Production outage at midnight

- Check CloudWatch alarms
- Inspect EC2 health
- Review application logs

Scenario 3

Hardcoded AWS keys in code

- Remove keys
- Use IAM roles
- Rotate credentials

Scenario 4

Need zero-downtime deployment

- Use Load Balancer
- Blue-Green strategy
- Health checks

7. One-Line AWS Best Practices (Interview Gold)

- Never use root account
 - Always use IAM roles
 - Enable CloudWatch alarms
 - Keep databases in private subnet
 - Enable S3 versioning
 - Monitor AWS billing daily
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8. How to Revise This Cheat-Sheet Before Interview

- Read once in morning
 - Read again before interview
 - Convert answers into your own words
 - Add project examples while answering
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